THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Chapters 1 & 2: **The Problem of Choice, The Price Puzzle** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** 3 hours of studying	time has an opportunity cost
2	**(c)** 30 wheat	difference in the good given up
3	**(a)** household management	oikos + nemein
4	**(a)** the value of the next best alternative given up	trade-off
5	**(b)** the trade-off between two goods with given resources	maximum combinations
6	**(c)** 18 kg	sum of individual demands
7	**(a)** ₹6	QD = QS = 40
8	**(b)** excess demand (shortage)	QD − QS
9	**(c)** market demand	adds up
10	**(d)** raise the demand for most goods	more purchasing power

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	An economy in which the government makes the main economic decisions and owns most resources (1); former Soviet Union or China before 1978 (1).	1+1
12	An economy in which production and prices are decided mainly by demand and supply with private ownership (2).	2
13	Fall in cost of inputs, improved technology, good weather, subsidies (1+1).	1+1
14	A situation where quantity demanded equals quantity supplied and the price is stable (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Surveys collect data on behaviour of households and firms (1.5); the data help analyse alternatives and policies (1.5).	1½+1½
16	Excess supply creates unsold stock (1); sellers reduce price (1); price falls till QD = QS (1).	1+1+1
17	Households allocating income; firms deciding production; government deciding taxes and welfare (1+1+1).	1+1+1
	OR: Building one means giving up the other (1.5); the benefit of the next best option is the opportunity cost (1.5).	1½+1½
18	Excess demand creates a shortage (1); buyers bid price up (1); price rises to equilibrium (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Equilibrium price ₹30 with 60 units (1.5); excess demand at ₹10 = 100 − 20 = 80 (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Curve showing maximum combinations of two goods with given resources (1). (ii) More of one good requires giving up the other; curve bends outwards because resources are not equally suitable (2). (iii) Inside: under-utilisation; outside: not attainable (2).	1+2+2
	OR: (i) Scarcity of income, so a choice (1). (ii) Bag + pen or book + pen (1). (iii) Book or bag respectively (1). (iv) Pick the combination with greatest benefit (2).	1+1+1+2
20	(i) Fairness, protect consumers and workers (1). (ii) Maximum and minimum prices (2). (iii) Sanitiser price; minimum wage or MSP (2).	1+2+2
	OR: (i) Single seller controlling supply (1). (ii) Higher price, poor quality, less choice (2). (iii) Regulations and competition laws (2).	1+2+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Chapters 1 & 2: **The Problem of Choice, The Price Puzzle** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** demand and supply	private ownership
2	**(c)** enterprises have little motivation to innovate	no competition
3	**(b)** water and improves soil health	sustainable choice
4	**(b)** handloom weaving	uses many workers
5	**(b)** Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	true but R does not explain A
6	**(a)** upward	direct relation
7	**(d)** excess demand	shortage pushes the price up
8	**(b)** monopoly	no close substitutes
9	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	buyers switch
10	**(d)** reduce the demand for the other	used together

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	An economy combining features of market and planned systems (1); India after 1991 and Germany (1).	1+1
12	Competition improves quality and lowers prices; encourages innovation and efficiency (1+1).	1+1
13	Supply exceeds demand, there is excess supply and the price tends to fall (2).	2
14	A maximum price fixed by the government, e.g. ₹100 cap on sanitisers (2).	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Pure markets ignore welfare and public goods; pure planning lacks incentives (1.5); hence most economies are mixed (1.5).	1½+1½
16	Demand and supply keep changing with income, weather, tastes and costs, so the price keeps adjusting (3).	3
17	Labour-intensive uses more workers, e.g. handloom (1.5); capital-intensive uses more machines, e.g. automobile plants (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: It makes people compare alternatives (1.5), so that scarce resources are put to their best use (1.5).	1½+1½
18	To ensure fairness for essential goods (1); to protect consumers, workers and producers (1); to prevent monopoly and black marketing (1).	1+1+1
	OR: During an emergency prices rose sharply (1); the government capped the price at ₹100 under the Essential Commodities Act (1); it became available at fair prices (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Consumers buy, producers supply, government regulates, banks lend (3). (ii) Wages earned and spent; taxes used for welfare (2).	3+2
	OR: (i) To decide distribution (1). (ii) Rich buy more and different goods (2). (iii) Affordable shoes for students and leather shoes for office-goers (2).	1+2+2
20	(i) Illegal sale at higher prices (1). (ii) Shortage with high demand (1). (iii) Consumers (1). (iv) Strict laws, online booking, more supply (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Goods used by all and not easily priced (1). (ii) Roads, parks, defence, sanitation (2). (iii) Private firms would not supply them without profit (2).	1+2+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET C

Chapters 1 & 2: **The Problem of Choice, The Price Puzzle** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the school that could have been built	scarce land
2	**(a)** 30 cloth	difference in the good given up
3	**(d)** resources are limited while wants are unlimited	scarcity
4	**(b)** what, how and for whom to produce	all economies face them
5	**(a)** under-use of resources	inefficiency
6	**(b)** 11 kg	sum of individual demands
7	**(c)** 80	QD − QS
8	**(b)** willing and able to buy at a given price	desire plus purchasing power
9	**(a)** substitutes	can replace each other
10	**(d)** diminishing marginal utility	the third mango

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Little motivation for innovation and quality, and delay in decisions (2).	2
12	It gives facts on production, prices, population and trends so choices are based on evidence, not guesswork (2).	2
13	A minimum price fixed above the market price, e.g. minimum support price (2).	2
14	One seller controls the supply with no substitutes (1); it charges higher prices and offers poorer quality (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Investing in education and infrastructure raises future growth (1.5); heavy consumption now may reduce future savings (1.5).	1½+1½
16	A lower limit set above the market wage (1.5); it protects workers from exploitation (1.5).	1½+1½
17	Giving up one thing to get another (1); more time on games means less time to study (2).	1+2
	OR: Resources are limited relative to wants for every country (3).	3
18	A single seller sets higher prices and lower quality (1.5); government regulates unfair practices and promotes competition (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Goods for public use such as roads and defence (1); private firms cannot easily charge for them, so government provides them (2).	1+2

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Labour-intensive and capital-intensive (1). (ii) Labour-intensive (1). (iii) Capital-intensive (1). (iv) Labour gives jobs; machines raise output but reduce employment (2).	1+1+1+2
	OR: (i) Wants always exceed resources (2). (ii) Setting priorities, saving, reducing waste and using technology (3).	2+3
20	(i) Rise in demand raises price; rise in supply lowers price (3). (ii) Mangoes in season, onions after a bad harvest (2).	3+2
	OR: (i) Excess demand early; excess supply later (1). (ii) Rises as price falls (1). (iii) Signals scarcity and balances the market (1). (iv) Good weather, transport, storage (2).	1+1+1+2

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET D

Chapters 1 & 2: **The Problem of Choice, The Price Puzzle** | Class 9 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** market and planned economies	private and public sectors
2	**(d)** a referee in a football match	law and order
3	**(a)** a household	consumers, producers, government
4	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	scarcity forces trade-off
5	**(d)** A is false but R is true	A is false
6	**(a)** a fall in the cost of inputs	cheaper production
7	**(b)** price ceiling	e.g. on sanitisers in an emergency
8	**(d)** black marketing	banned or controlled goods
9	**(d)** A is false but R is true	ceiling is below equilibrium
10	**(c)** many sellers offering close substitutes	monopoly vs competition

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It reports how the Indian economy performed and guides the Union Budget (2).	2
12	It studies how choices are made on limited resources, including time, labour and land (2).	2
13	Selling goods at illegally high prices or selling banned goods (2).	2
14	Street lights, roads, national defence, sanitation (1+1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Helps in personal choices such as budgeting; helps understand policies and the Union Budget; helps evaluate the use of public resources (1+1+1).	1+1+1
16	May reduce supply and lead to shortages (1.5); black marketing may arise (1.5).	1½+1½
17	Needs are essentials (food); wants are desires (gadgets); luxuries are costly wants beyond normal income (1+1+1).	1+1+1
	OR: Profit and market demand matter (1.5); water use and soil health decide sustainability (1.5).	1½+1½
18	Too many licences and compliance procedures raise costs and delays (1.5); fewer start-ups and slower growth (1.5).	1½+1½
	OR: Higher input costs reduce profit and supply (1.5); better technology lowers cost and raises supply, e.g. cold storage for mangoes (1.5).	1½+1½

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	(i) Ownership, decision maker, role of prices, examples (3). (ii) Mixed, because it combines efficiency with welfare (2).	3+2
	OR: (i) Giving up one thing to get another (1). (ii) With fixed resources, moving along the curve gives up one good for the other (2). (iii) By more resources, better technology and skills (2).	1+2+2
20	(i) Raise cost and delay (2). (ii) Simplify rules, ensure competition (2). (iii) Protect fairness and provide public goods (1).	2+2+1
	OR: (i) By the interaction of demand and supply (1). (ii) Buyers offer what they are willing to pay and sellers what they will accept (2). (iii) Freshness and unsold stock force sellers to lower prices in the evening (2).	1+2+2

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.